
Smart Subscription Dashboard: Revealing Hidden Spending Patterns in R Shiny

 Live App: <https://meenalwadhwa-rfundamentals.shinyapps.io/SmartSubscription/>

The idea

We all sign up for subscriptions thinking they're "just a few dollars a month"—music, cloud storage, gaming, productivity tools. Over time, these small charges quietly add up in the background without much attention.

This project was built with a simple goal: to create an interactive R Shiny dashboard that helps users clearly see and understand their subscription spending across categories, status, and cost.

Instead of static reports or spreadsheets, it offers a real-time exploratory experience where users can filter, interact with the data, and instantly uncover meaningful spending patterns in a clean and intuitive way.

What was built

This project is an interactive **R Shiny dashboard** designed to explore subscription spending in a clear and engaging way.

It brings together key tools from the R ecosystem, including readr for dataset loading, dplyr for data transformation, ggplot2 and plotly for interactive visualizations, lubridate for handling dates, and shinyWidgets for an enhanced user interface.

The dashboard uses interactive visualizations such as bar charts, donut charts, and dynamic tables to explore spending patterns . It is structured around a curated dataset of subscriptions containing details such as subscription name, category, status, monthly cost, start date, and renewal date.

Everything is brought together in a dynamic interface where users can filter data, adjust spending ranges, set budget limits, and explore renewals—all updating instantly to reflect their selections.

Smart Subscription Dashboard

Filters

Category

Cloud, Productivity, News, Fitness, Music, Gaming, Entertainment

Status

☒ All

☐ Active

☐ Inactive

Spending

Monthly Spend Range

0

60

0102030405060

Monthly Budget

1600

Renewals

Today

2026-05-04

Show Next (Days)

90

Dashboard Layout with Interactive Input Selectors

How the interaction works

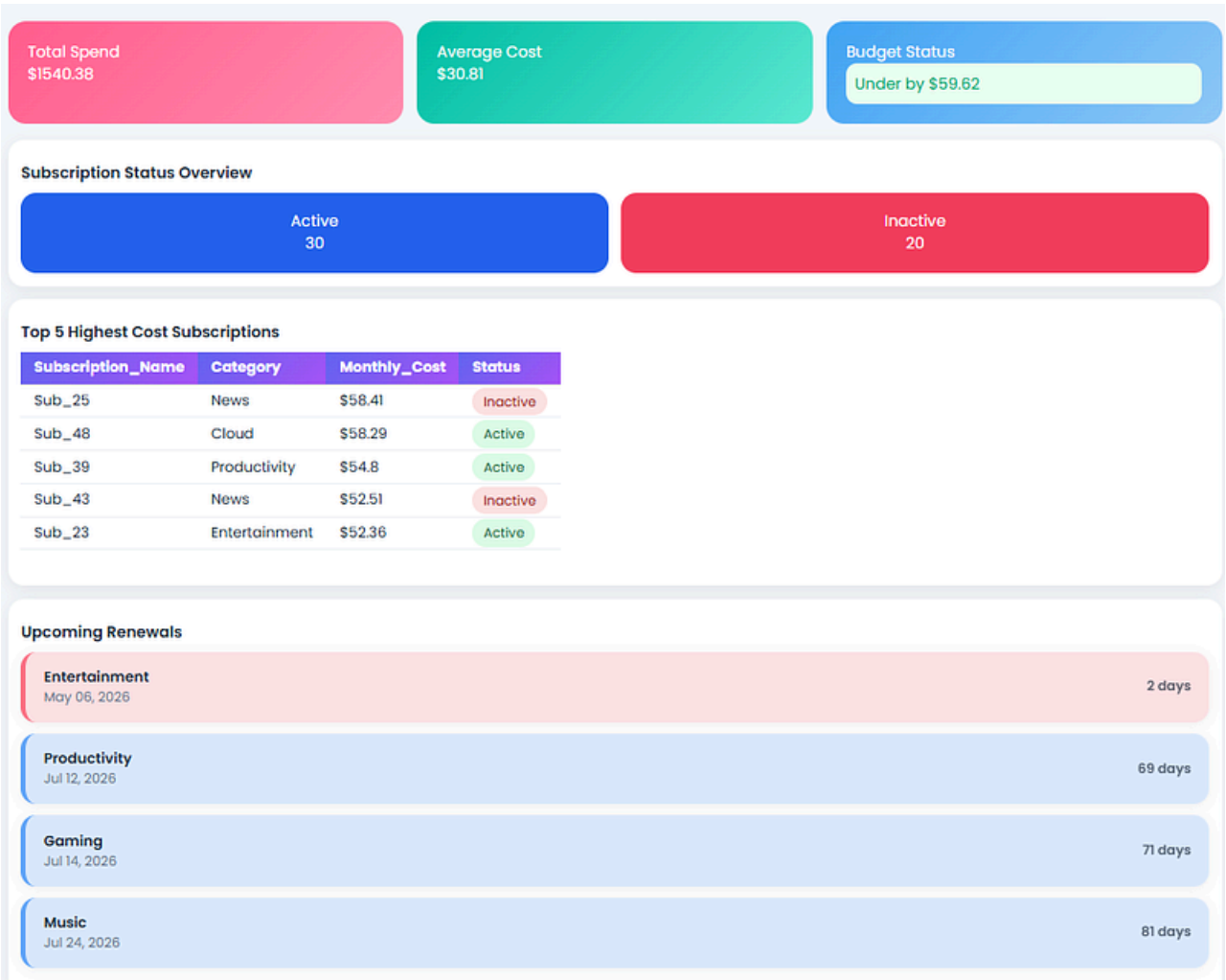
The dashboard is easy to use and updates instantly as you interact with it.

You can filter by category and status, adjust the **monthly spend range**, and see all charts, tables, and KPIs change in real time.

You can also set a **monthly budget** to compare your total spending and see if you are within or over your limit.

For renewals, you can select the **next number of days** (like 30, 60, or 90) to view upcoming subscription dates.

Everything is connected, so every change you make is immediately reflected across the dashboard, making it simple to explore and understand your subscriptions.



Real-Time Changes

What the dashboard shows

The dashboard gives you a simple, interactive way to explore your subscription data in real time.

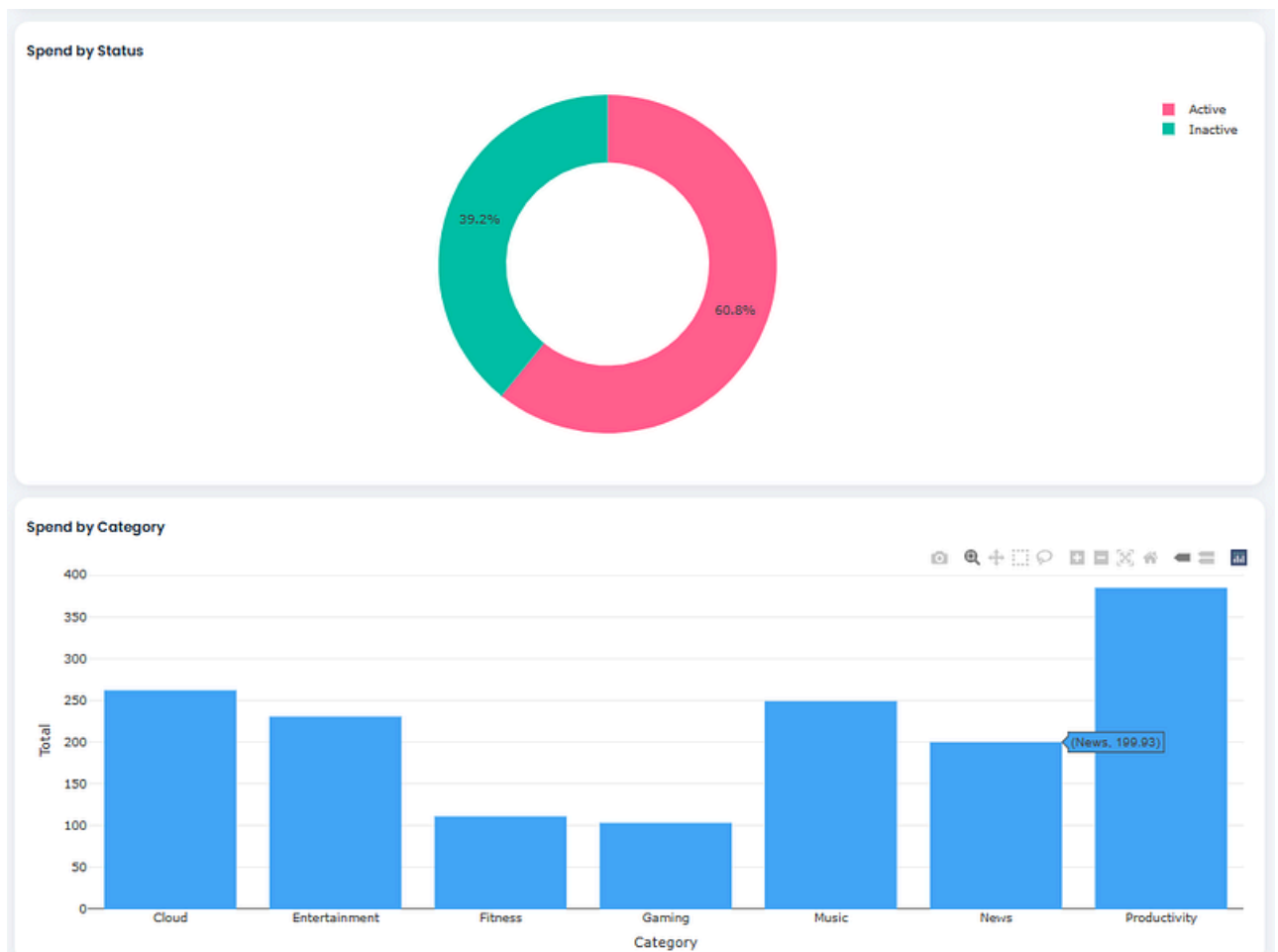
At the top, key insights like total monthly spend, average cost, and budget status update instantly as you apply filters.

You can switch between categories and status to see how your spending changes, and immediately view how much is active vs inactive.

A section highlights your top 5 highest-cost subscriptions, updating dynamically based on what you select, so you can quickly see where most of the spend is concentrated.

You can also interact with upcoming renewals by selecting the number of days (like 30, 60, or 90) to instantly see what's coming up next.

Finally, interactive charts show spending by status and category—hover over them to explore details and get a clear view of your spending patterns in real time.



Spending Insights

Final thoughts

This project shows how raw data can be turned into something interactive, visual, and easy to explore using R Shiny. Instead of looking at static numbers, users can interact with their data, filter it in different ways, and instantly see how their subscription spending changes.

It also highlights how small design and interactivity choices—like filters, live updates, and visual breakdowns—can make data feel more intuitive and meaningful. Overall, it was a great way to combine data wrangling, visualization, and UI design into one clean, functional dashboard.

By [Meenal Wadhwa](#) on [April 25, 2026](#).

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